

September 2025

Q3 2025 REPORT

ABOUT US



Lakehub was founded with the belief that investing in tech education and development of Africa's youth is essential for the growth and progress of the continent, and it is committed to providing the resources and support that these young people need to reach their full potential.

Through **Zone01 Kisumu**, we provide youths from all backgrounds with an opportunity to learn software development from scratch through peer-to-peer activities after which, they are guaranteed employment contracts of at least 3 years.

We are based in Kisumu, Kenya.

Mission

Our mission is to decentralize access to technology tools and resources, making them readily available to young people in underserved areas. By providing comprehensive tech education, mentorship programs, and access to cutting-edge technology, we equip young individuals with the skills and resources necessary to succeed in a digital economy

We are the only convener and trainer of young technologists in Kenya's lake region.



A message from our

SITE DIRECTOR: CALEB NYOIRO

The past quarter has been pivotal in our growth and we are glad to share our Q3 report documenting this journey with you, our friends, partners and stakeholders.

To begin with, our Cohort 1 Trainees have successfully completed the first part (18-month tuition-free training) of their training journey! Yaay! We extend our heartfelt gratitude to our partners who have made this milestone achievable.

The first 18 months of our 24-month training involves the core technical training followed by 6 months of specialization where our talent select their path in tech. We began in April 2024 therefore September 2025 marks the end of the 18-month core training period.

Starting Q4 (October 2025), the trainees will embark on their career pathways journey till March 2026. And picking from the current technology trends, we are glad that all our developers have picked Artificial Intelligence as a mandatory specialization alongside other complementary pathways like Blockchain, Mobile and Web App Development, CyberSecurity and DevOps, Games Development, and Data Engineering.

In the month ending September 2025, we successfully placed 6 of our developers in high-level full time roles. 5 landed remote roles with a foreign partner company while the other got an office placement in Nairobi.

Within this period, we have also successfully onboarded **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)** and **Australian-based company RishiFlow** as our additional project partners.

The UNDP project has absorbed 10 of our developers and RishiFlow has taken in 5 thereby bringing the total number of our developers engaged in paid projects to 31. It is noteworthy that some of the developers are now earning a net income of USD 500. This is a testament to our commitment and those of our partners to improve livelihoods since these trainees with the exception of 2 joined us with a zero net income.

In August, one of our trainees received a partial scholarship to attend a residency program in Singapore. We are proud that they have flown our flag high in the Southeast Asian city-state. He spent the entire September actively participating in collaborative projects, networking with international experts, and sharpening his skills in cutting-edge technologies that directly align with the future of innovation in software and Artificial Intelligence.

As he travels back to join us, we are sure that this opportunity has not only contributed significantly to their personal and professional growth but will also bring valuable insights, knowledge, and potential collaborations to Zone01 Kisumu (and LakeHub Foundation).

As we step into the last quarter of 2025, we are indeed very grateful for your dedicated support. We assure you of our continued commitment to increasing access to digital education, resources and jobs.

Thank you.

QUARTER 3 IN NUMBERS

COHORT I

90	Apprentices have completed the 18-month software development training
75	Apprentices engaged in project work, both paid and unpaid
31	Current apprentices already placed in jobs, earning an average of USD 250 including...
12	women apprentices currently engaged in paid tech work.

COHORT II RECRUITMENT

252	Applicants participated in 1 month pre-selection stage
16	women introduced to coding
52	youths selected to join Cohort II

CUMULATIVE IMPACT SINCE 2023

20400+	Applications received so far including....
7,250	applications by women
875	youths have participated in 1 month pre-selection stage bootcamps with 160 being women
152	Youths selected for software development training leading to employment. 35 being women



OUR Q3 IMPACT

TRANSITIONING FROM TRAINEES TO EMPLOYEES

In July and August 2025, Kenyan universities and colleges graduated more than 400,000 youths. By the end of 2025, 600,000 more will graduate from over 80 higher learning institutions across Kenya. For these graduates, entering the job market is daunting given Kenya's unemployment rate that has risen to 69%.

We set up **Zone01 Kisumu** to offer these youths an alternative path to employment. Our 2-year upskilling in coding skills followed by 3-year job placement has unlocked career opportunities for young Kenyans who previously had little hope of joining employment ranks.

Selection Piscines - Recruiting for Cohort II

In Q3, a further **131 youths** benefited from our 4-week intense training in Go language, bringing the total number of **youths trained in 2025 to 331**. In November 2025, we are scheduled to open our doors to 120 more applicants who will be trained in Go language.

Further, we selected 20 more youths in Q3 (July, August and September 2025) to join our second cohort. The selected youths join the 31 hopefuls we selected in Q1 and Q2 to take part in our two-year tuition-free training at Zone01 Kisumu. All 51 youths are now on the path to full-time employment at Zone01 Kisumu.

"I have wanted to join Zone01 Kisumu for two years. I am so happy that I have been selected for Cohort II. I'm lost for words. I am going to work even harder, join the user groups because I want to keep learning Go." Valery Odinga, Selected to join Cohort II"

In Q3, we placed all 75 Cohort I apprentices in projects. 31 apprentices were placed in paid roles with local and international clients earning an average income of USD 250. We also witnessed Evarest, the first start up TO emerge from Zone01 Kisumu. Four apprentices founded their own start up, a major milestone and endorsement of our pedagogy.

Partnerships Open Employment Paths for Apprentices

In Q3, we kicked off our partnership with UNDP to strengthen agricultural sustainability in Tana River, Garissa, Turkana and West Pokot, areas considered as Kenya's arid and semi-arid counties. We sent a team from Zone01 Kisumu to conduct a user needs assessment before starting the design and deployment of a mobile-first digital marketing application. We have also partnered with Siaya Community Digital Hub to expand tech education to the residents of Siaya County.



Aoron Ochieng'
Zone01 Kisumu Talent placed at Rishiflow AI

EVAREST: FROM APPRENTICES TO A FLEDGLING TECH START-UP

FOUR FULLSTACK DEVELOPERS LAUNCH THEIR START UP FOLLOWING COMPLETION OF ZONE01 KISUMU TECH TRAINING

Like proud parents seeing their kids leave the nest to go make their own path in an unforgiving world filled with numerous opportunities for success, we are proud to share that four apprentices have left Zone01 Kisumu to form Evarest, fledgling Kenyan start-up that is carving out a niche in the "Engineering-as-a-Service" market.

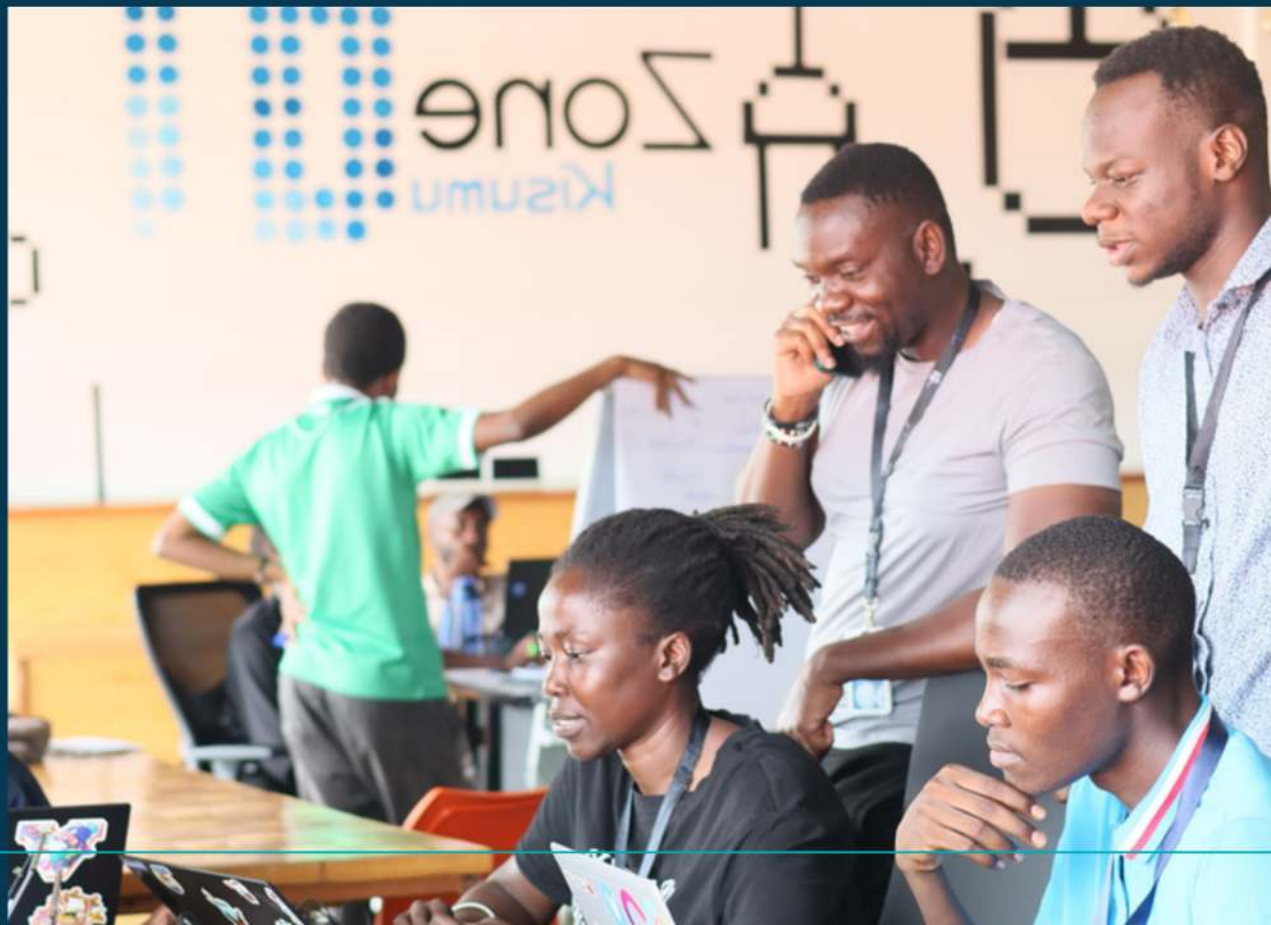
The close-knit team behind the company is made up of software engineers Stella Oiro, Vincent Odhiambo, Seth Athooh, and Raymond Caleb who completed Zone01 Kisumu's 18-month tuition free software development training in September 2025.

From their early days at Zone01 Kisumu, Seth, Stella, Vincent and Raymnond showed remarkable promise by consistently building excellent solutions in internal and external hackathons. The team has been feted several times in competitions across the last 18-months.

Evarest has positioned itself as a partner that bridges the gap between product ambition and technical delivery for its clients. They will focus on providing tech solutions in Healthtech, Fintech and AI & Automation as their core business.

As they build their start-up from the ground up, we are happy to mention Evarest's flagship project called Rokkni.com, a digital marketplace that connects organic producers with global markets. The product is built using Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, and AWS, ensuring speed, scalability, and a seamless user experience.

Everest leaves Zone01 Kisumu with our unreserved blessings and best wishes for the future. Everest success is our success and we will cheer them on every step of the way as the conquer the world.



From Left (Seated): Stella Oiro and Vincent Omondi
From Left (Standing): Seth Athooh and Raymnond Caleb

ONGOING PROJECTS @ ZONE01 KISUMU



UNDP's Advancing Food Systems Resilience Project

What our Talent are building: Designing and deploying a mobile-first digital marketing application to complement training and capacity-building interventions targeting at least 400 smallholder farmers and cooperative members. The platform will be tailored for low-literacy, low-connectivity environments and will be inclusive of women, youth, and marginalised groups.

Area of impact: Northern Kenya county farmers and buyers (Turkana, Tana River, Garissa, Turkana and West Pokot)

Project Lead: Stacy Dina
Project Team: John Odhiambo (Technical PM), Joel Amos, Hannah Apiko (Designers), Andy Osyndoh, Wycliffe Onyango, Tomlee Abila, Abraham King'oo

Feedback from 01 Talent Kenya
"Impressive work done given the little timeframe since the User needs Assessment! The designs showcased will meet the community needs" - ***Kevin Mutuku,*** *UNDP Project Lead*



Rishiflow

About Rishiflow - A platform that seeks to enhance educational experiences with its AI powered apps. Rishiflow intends to maximize learning outcomes and foster a culture of knowledge enrichment and growth.

What our Apprentices are building - A learning mobile application designed to facilitate seamless knowledge transfer and one that provides personalized learning experiences. They will leverage smart automation tools to ensure that the app adapts to the unique learning styles of individuals.

Project Manager: Josephine Opondo
Project Team: Anne Maina, Kaunda Rodgers, Teddy Siaka, Aoron Ochieng'

Feedback from Berrijam AI
"Our initial engagement has been nothing but positive. We are familiar with the work that Zone01 Kisumu did fro Berrijam so you came highly recommended "- ***Jagriti Misra****, Founder, Rishiflow*



BongoHub (Approaching Completion)

About BongoHub - BongoHub is a digital platform connecting creative professionals, change-makers, and organizations across East Africa. Bongohub transcends geographical limitations even as it strengthens its existing regional initiatives.

What our Apprentices are building - Our team is completing the final iteration of BongoHub's online platform. The team has used Ruby on Rails and React/Inertia technology stack. Through testing, the digital infrastructure our team has build has enabled BongoHub to scale its impact while maintaining the collaborative spirit that defines its community.

Project Lead: Josephine Opondo
Project Team: Andrew Osindo, Abraham Maiko, Rodgers Kaunda, John Eliud

Feedback from BongoHub
"The talent we've worked with have delivered beyond expectations." - ***Angelika Farhan-Reimpell,*** *Bongo Hub, Founder*



Impact Story

FERDYNAND ODHIAMBO

Existential Crisis Settled By Zone01 Kisumu

Ferdynand Odhiambo first walked through the gates of Chuka University in 2022 to pursue Biomedical Studies. Ideally, he should have been smiling from ear to ear as he stepped into his first class, ready to start a four year journey that would lead him to a well-paying job. Instead, he was filled with dread. He was unsettled and unhappy. Like thousands of youth reporting to the university, he found himself trapped in a program he had no passion for.

His heart desired computers. He'd been fascinated by computers since he first saw one in Form 3 (Grade 11). He applied to study computers at Chuka University, yet he was placed in medical studies by the school. Egged on by his parents, he was forced to study a subject that did not inspire him at all. One semester in, something had to give. He initiated a transfer to Technical University of Mombasa to pursue Computer Science.

At TUM, Ferdynand's passion for coding burned bright. Perhaps too bright. As he approached his second year, that familiar unease set in. Universities in Kenya take time to update their static curriculum which is often condensed and left with limited depth of knowledge. Yet through his self-learning, Ferdynand was keeping pace with the latest languages shaping software engineering globally. His debilitating social anxiety also didn't help him settle down at TUM. He dropped out of school again.

Ferdynand spent hours online teaching himself code and searching for opportunities. That's when he discovered Zone01 Kisumu, a new, digital center that teaches code tuition-free, using peer-to-peer, self-paced learning to impart cutting-edge coding skills. Zone01 Kisumu spoke to his heart in a way that no other institution/program had. But with programs only available in Kisumu City, the dream seemed out of reach for a student stuck 800km on the opposite side of the country in Mombasa, Kenya.

Nevertheless, he applied, waited patiently for months, and was finally invited to join. For Ferdynand, this was more than just a third chance. It was exactly what he dreamed and hoped for.

"Zone01 Kisumu gave me the opportunity to pursue my passion without limitations. I might be awkward sometimes but the model and the curriculum is exactly what I want. It has given me clarity. I can visualize my future in tech clearly."

Today, Ferdynand is one of the most promising Fullstack Developers. He is on a path to employment and dreams of applying his coding expertise to Artificial Intelligence and Blockchain technologies to solve health challenges in his community and beyond.



ZONE 01 KISUMU AND SIAYA COMMUNITY DIGITAL HUB PARTNER TO BOOST DIGITAL INNOVATION

We are thrilled to report that Zone 01 Kisumu has initiated contact with Siaya Community Digital Hub regarding a strategic collaboration aimed at advancing digital literacy among youths in Siaya County. The proposed partnership underscores our shared mission to build a generation of tech talent equipped with the skills needed to thrive in the global digital economy.

Zone01 Kisumu's Managing Director, Dorcas Owino, through an invite by the Deputy Governor of Kisumu, Dr. Mathew Owili and Siaya County Senator, Dr. Oburu Odinga, visited the Siaya Community Digital Hub where she was warmly welcomed by Tabitha Ogutu, the Hub's CEO.
One of the key areas of collaboration between Zone01 Kisumu and Siaya Community Digital Hub will be the joint-execution of hackathons and problem-solving challenges focused on artificial intelligence (AI). These hackathons will allow Siaya youths to explore real-world challenges, sharpen their analytical thinking, and apply digital tools to design sustainable solutions for their communities.

Further, the partnership will explore the possibility of holding a joint cohort targeting participants in and around Siaya County who may not be able to attend the in-person training at the Zone 01 Kisumu's main clusters in Kisumu County. We hope that this cohort will serve as a foundational pathway ensuring more young people can access opportunities to learn and grow.

Beyond training, we intend to host events and workshops aimed at promoting digital literacy and fostering a culture of innovation across Western Kenya region. Through this partnership, Zone 01 Kisumu and the Siaya Community Digital Hub are not only expanding access to technology education but also empowering youth to become problem solvers, innovators, and active contributors to Kenya's digital future.



BUILDING RESILIENT FOOD SYSTEMS IN NORTHERN KENYA

We're thrilled to announce our partnership with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) to strengthen agricultural sustainability in Tana River, Garissa, Turkana, and West Pokot, Kenya's arid and semi-arid counties.

Through UNDP's Advancing Food Systems Resilience Project, Zone01 Kisumu's tech talent is designing and deploying a mobile-first digital marketing platform that connects smallholder farmers and cooperatives to markets and opportunities. The platform is being built for low-literacy, low-connectivity environments.

To ensure the solution is grounded in real community needs, Stacy Dina, the project lead, and John Eliud, full-stack developer from Zone01Kisumu, completed a user needs assessment mission across Northern Kenya. They engaged farmers, buyers, and cooperatives to co-design a tool that will truly reflect their realities paving the way for a more connected, resilient, and sustainable agricultural future. Seven full stack developers from Zone01 Kisumu are currently engaged building the digital platform.



PARTNERING THROUGH EVENTS IN Q3



Bavaria–Kenya ICT Business Networking Event

This gathering of key stakeholders from government, industry, and development partners explored collaboration opportunities in technology and innovation.

Sector-focused discussions showcased the role of ICT in transforming health, education, and the banking sector, with particular emphasis on digital health solutions, e-learning platforms, and fintech innovation.

The Bankers Association of Kenya outlined technology gaps and opportunities around real-time payments, cloud-native core banking, data analytics, and cybersecurity, setting the stage for meaningful partnerships between Zone01 Kisumu, Kenyan and Bavarian enterprises to advance digital transformation across sectors.



Capture the Productivity Pirates -Planning Lives Fully Lived by Dr. Heinz Plaumann, PhD

To prepare our Software Developers for roles in the global tech space, we hosted Dr. Heinz Plaumann, a distinguished Fellow of the Chemical Institute of Canada and Adjunct Professor of Chemical Engineering and Material Science at Wayne State University, Detroit, U.S.A for a seminar on Time Management and Productivity.

We were first introduced to Dr. Plaumann at the just ended Mandela Washington Fellowship in Detroit and he was kind enough to offer free training workshops for Zone01 Kisumu apprentices.

This collaboration has imparted important global experience and context to our apprentices, making them understand the nuances in work cultures and communication



Women in Engineering Day

Powered by Code & Circuits and the ARM Developer Program, Zone01 Kisumu software developers reflected on the reality of being leading women in tech and overcoming imposter syndrome.

This session also shared practical advice for women navigating STEM careers in Kenya's growing tech ecosystem, discussing how to build confidence, find mentors, and stay authentic in this fast-evolving field.

The key lesson that resonated throughout this discussion was that true engineering excellence goes beyond technical skills, that it's about developing resilience when projects fail, embracing collaboration across differences, and most importantly, owning everyone's uniqueness in every room.

CHALLENGES IN Q3

ZONE0 KISUMU APPRENTICE CONTRACT RENEGOTIATIONS WAS A TOUGH PERIOD FOR ALL OF US

Zone01 Kisumu has revised its apprenticeship bonding agreement to reflect shifts in the software development job market. Starting September 2025, after the 18-month training program, apprentices will transition from fixed salaries to a project-based income-share model. This change allows apprentices to earn based on project value, offering greater income potential and flexibility. Penalties tied to previous contracts have been removed, enabling apprentices to pursue external opportunities freely.

The renegotiation process involved open discussions led by Managing Director Dorcas Owino and Site Director Caleb Nyoiro, consultations with Partners For Equity, 01 Talent, and the County Government of Kisumu, as well as legal reviews to ensure compliance with Kenyan labour laws. Multiple town halls were held for apprentices to give feedback, fostering transparency and trust.

Of the 90 apprentices, **75 agreed to the new terms, 6 have been placed in roles by Zone01 Kisumu and 9 opted for other paths**. Training and partner projects continue smoothly, and apprentice morale has improved as they recognize the potential for higher earnings and long-term growth at Zone01 Kisumu.

This new model enhances both financial sustainability for Zone01 Kisumu and fair compensation for apprentices. Regular progress updates will be provided.









LEARNING TO LEAD @ 2025 MANDELA WASHINGTON FELLOWSHIP FOR YOUNG AFRICAN LEADERS

LakeHub was honored to welcome back Caleb Nyoiro, the Zone01 Kisumu Site Director, following his selection and participation in the 2025 Mandela Washington Fellowship for Young African Leaders. The fellowship, hosted at Wayne State University in Detroit, Michigan, provided intensive training in Leadership in Public Management and offered an immersive platform for knowledge exchange, networking, and professional growth.

The fellowship also provided opportunities for Caleb to engage with a diverse cohort of Kenyan changemakers, ranging from social workers, government officials, and medical professionals to engineers, climate experts, educators, and civic leaders on behalf of LakeHub and Zone01 Kisumu. Collectively, the cohort highlighted the wealth of talent and innovation present in Kenya and underscored the value of collaboration in addressing both national and global challenges.

We extend our appreciation to the U.S. Embassy in Kenya, the staff at Wayne State University's Office of International Programs, and the Mandela Washington Fellowship community for their role in making this experience impactful not just for the Site Director, but the entire Zone01 Kisumu community. The insights gained will not only strengthen individual leadership capacity but also contribute to the broader mission of fostering innovation and positive change within our community.





KIJANISPACE TO FEATURE @ THE UNOSSC

Kijanispace has been invited to feature on the United Nations Office for South-South Cooperation (UNOSSC) 's South-South Galaxy platform.

LakeHub, a key partner and stakeholder in the project is proud to play a critical role in the success of the consortium that first met at Zone01 Kisumu in April 2025 in a multi-stakeholder workshop that brought together policymakers, researchers, farmers and innovators to shape a resilient future for the Lake Victoria Basin.

The news follows the success of the East Africa KijaniSpace Stakeholders meeting in Mwanza, Tanzania which highlighted the power of space science as a catalyst for sustainable growth in the East Africa region and Africa as a continent. This need that was clear to see for all attendees during the visit to Luchele Beach (left), where fish farming initiatives are part of a localised approach to sustainable aquaculture.

Kijanispace empowers climate-smart agriculture with Copernicus and IoT innovations for smallholder farmers in Africa. It's a clear testament to how European-African partnerships can harness space data, the Internet of Things (IoT), and collaborative innovation to make farming more resilient, sustainable, and inclusive.



KEY DATES/EVENTS IN Q4

NASA SPACE APPS CHALLENGE

ZONE01 KISUMU

OCT 2

A first for East and Central Africa! NASA Space Apps Challenge 2025 comes to Kisumu and we are extremely excited to host it at Zone01 Kisumu.



COHORT III SELECTION (PISCINE IX)

ZONE01 KISUMU ROTARY VTC

NOV 3

Our final piscine to select the most promising canditates to join Zone01 Kisumu starts on September 1st 2025 at Rotary Vocational Centre



MOZILLA FESTIVAL

BARCELONA, SPAIN

NOV 7-9

We are joining a gathering made up of the world's most curious and creative minds for three days of workshops, debates, and hands-on collaboration in Barcelona, Spain.



MEET OUR TEAM

At the heart of **LakeHub** is a team dedicated to empowering youth through transformative tech education. Our team is committed to building a future where opportunity is driven by skills, innovation, and collaboration. We foster a supportive, inclusive environment that nurtures talent and drives lasting social impact across Western Kenya and beyond.



Dorcas Owinoh
Executive Director



Caleb Nyoiro
Site Director



Paul Oguda
Head of Tech



Chris Arunga
Talent Manager



Lydiah Ojowi
Finance Manager



Deril Ouko
Comms Lead



Bellah Oyucho
Tech



Stacy Dina
Tech



Alpha Omondi
Tech



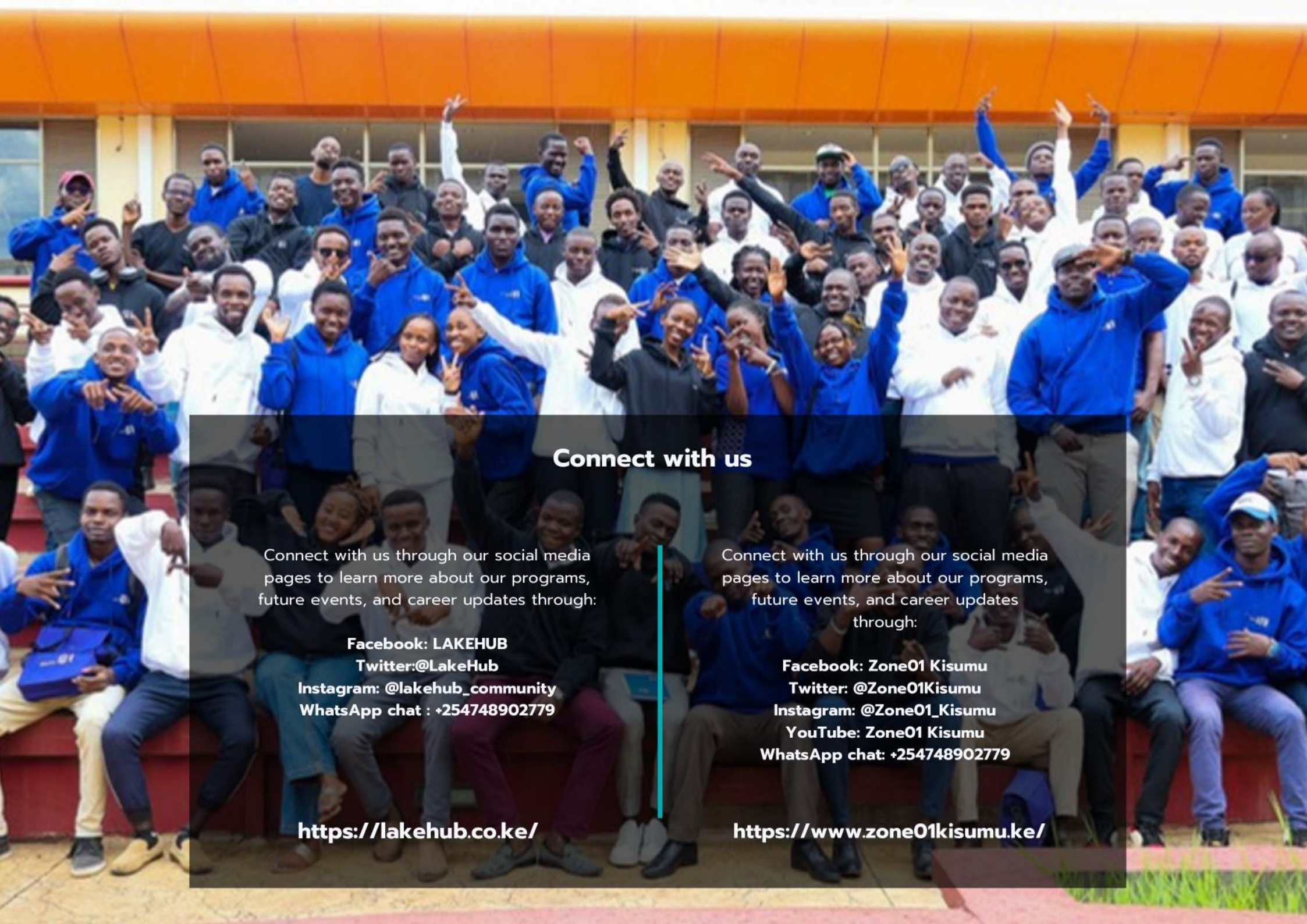
Daisy Achieng
Comms Associate

STATEMENT OF EXPENDITURE FOR Q3 2025

Between July and September, a total of **USD 18,735** was raised, of which **USD 12,256 (65%)** came from project income. Total expenses for the same period amounted to **USD 115,718**, resulting in an operational deficit of **USD 96,983**. After factoring in funds received from previous periods, the closing balance stands at a surplus of **USD 84,472**.

Opening Balance	**181,455**
Revenues	
Grant Inflows	6,479
Other earnings (Project Income)	12,256
Total Revenues	**18,735**
Expenses	
Program Expenses	
Apprentice Stipends	39,823
Online Subscriptions, Ads & Dues	4,631
Rentals and consumables	14,735
Repairs and Maintenance	607
Total Program Expenses	**59,796**
Operational Cost	
Admin Costs	496
Salaries & Wages	45,235
Travel Out of Pocket & Accommodation	5,669
Marketing Costs	1,213
Other Capital Expenditure	1,431
Professional Fees	1,878
Total Operational Expenses	**55,922**
Total Expenses	**115,718**
Operational Surplus (Deficit)	**-96,983**
Closing Balance	**84,472**

*All amounts are in US Dollars ($).



Connect with us

Connect with us through our social media pages to learn more about our programs, future events, and career updates through:

Facebook: LAKEHUB
Twitter:@LakeHub
Instagram: @lakehub_community
WhatsApp chat : +254748902779

https://lakehub.co.ke/

Connect with us through our social media pages to learn more about our programs, future events, and career updates through:

Facebook: Zone01 Kisumu
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Instagram: @Zone01_Kisumu
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